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WEDNESDAY, MAY 21, 2025

Ex-PM leads free speech backlash as judges refuse to reduce mother's **31-month** jail term over hateful Southport tweet

BORIS: STARMER'S BRITAIN IS TURNING INTO POLICE STATE

By **Sam Greenhill** and **David Barrett**

BRITAIN is becoming a police state under Labour, Boris Johnson warned last night.

He spoke as a sentencing row erupted after a mother locked up for a tweet after the Southport murders failed in a bid to reduce her lengthy jail term.

Lucy Connolly posted a vile message about migrants – but supporters point out that criminals found guilty of far more serious offences have been handed substantially shorter sentences.

And former prime minister Mr Johnson warned that the country is 'losing its reputation for free speech' as a growing number of online rants draw the attention of police.

Connolly, 42, had asked the Court of Appeal to free her early from a 31-month sentence for inciting racial hatred, imposed after she posted a tweet urging people to 'set fire to the hotels' on the day of the triple murder last summer.

She posted it at a time of swirling misinformation online, including a claim that the

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